

IronStore Expense Reimbursement Policy

Policy ID: FIN-EXP-004

Owning area: Finance

Effective date: 1 September 2026

Last reviewed: August 2026

Policy owner: Director of Financial Control

1. Purpose and Overview

This policy defines how IronStore employees and approved contractors may incur, document, approve, and claim business expenses. It applies to spending made on behalf of IronStore in connection with work activities, including travel, meetings, customer or supplier events, and approved home-working requirements.

IronStore reimburses reasonable, necessary, and properly documented expenses. Employees must use company payment methods where available and select cost-effective options. Personal spending must not be used to bypass purchasing controls, approval limits, or supplier onboarding requirements.

Expenses are processed through **SpendHub**, IronStore's expense management system. Approved claims are paid through the employee's normal payroll or bank payment process, subject to local payroll and tax rules.

2. Scope

This policy applies to:

- All IronStore employees in European entities.
- Temporary workers and contractors where their contract permits reimbursement.
- Directors and senior leaders, unless a stricter local or board policy applies.
- Expenses paid personally or with an IronStore corporate card.
- Business travel, accommodation, meals, mileage, business hospitality, and approved incidental costs.

This policy does not cover:

- Supplier invoices or purchase orders, which must follow the **Procurement and Purchase Order Policy**.
- Relocation, immigration, or expatriate benefits.
- Salary, bonus, or other employment benefits.
- Personal commuting between home and the employee's normal workplace.
- Expenses prohibited by local law or an employee's employment contract.

Where local legislation provides a stricter requirement, the local requirement takes precedence. Finance may issue country-specific guidance for tax, VAT, mileage, or payroll treatment.

3. Policy Statement

3.1 General requirements

Employees must ensure that each expense is:

- Necessary for a legitimate IronStore business purpose.
- Reasonable in amount and proportionate to the activity.
- In line with this policy and any approved budget.
- Supported by a valid receipt or other acceptable evidence.
- Submitted within the required timeframe.
- Charged to the correct legal entity, department, project, and cost centre.

Employees must not approve their own expenses, split a transaction to avoid an approval threshold, or claim an expense more than once. Deliberate misuse may result in repayment, disciplinary action, or referral to Legal or Internal Audit.

The most economical practical option should be selected. A more expensive option may be used where it saves significant working time, supports accessibility needs, or is justified by operational requirements.

3.2 Corporate cards

Corporate cards are issued through **SpendHub Cards** and are intended for approved business spending only.

Cardholders must:

- Keep the card secure and never share card details.
- Use the card for travel bookings and recurring business expenses where practical.
- Upload receipts and business descriptions within five calendar days.
- Reconcile the monthly card statement by the fifth working day of the following month.
- Report lost cards or suspected fraud immediately to the bank and Finance Operations.

Personal purchases, cash withdrawals, fines, and entertainment unrelated to business are not permitted on a corporate card. Accidental personal charges must be reported in SpendHub and repaid within ten working days.

3.3 Pre-approval requirements

Written pre-approval is required before committing to:

- Any international business trip.
- Accommodation expected to exceed €200 per night, excluding taxes.
- Events, hospitality, or team activities exceeding €75 per attendee.
- Any single expense or booking above €1,000.
- Business-class rail or air travel.
- Travel involving a customer, supplier, or public official.

- Expenses outside an approved project or departmental budget.

Pre-approval is recorded in SpendHub or, for travel, in **TravelPerk**. The approval chain is normally:

1. Line manager.
2. Budget owner, where different.
3. Finance Business Partner for exceptions or higher-risk items.
4. Executive sponsor for commitments above €5,000.

Emergency spending may proceed without advance approval where delay would create a material business risk. The employee must document the reason and obtain retrospective approval within five working days.

3.4 Travel and transport

Travel must be booked through **TravelPerk**, using the employee's assigned country profile and approved payment method.

Permitted standards are:

- Economy class for flights and rail journeys under six hours.
- Premium economy for journeys exceeding six hours, where available and reasonably priced.
- Business class only with CFO approval or documented medical accommodation.
- Standard or equivalent rail fare unless a flexible ticket is needed for business reasons.
- Mid-range hotels with a normal business rate for the destination.
- Public transport, licensed taxis, and approved ride-hailing services.
- Rental cars in the compact or intermediate category unless equipment or passenger needs require more.

Travel should generally be booked at least 14 days in advance. Changes or cancellations must be made promptly to reduce fees. Seat upgrades, lounge access, minibar charges, in-room entertainment, and personal insurance are not reimbursable unless specifically approved.

Employees may use a private vehicle for business travel where practical. Mileage is reimbursed at the applicable national rate published by Finance, currently €0.30 per business kilometre in countries using the standard IronStore rate. The claim must show date, origin, destination, purpose, and kilometres. Normal commuting is excluded.

3.5 Meals and subsistence

Reasonable meals during approved business travel may be reimbursed within the following maximums:

- Breakfast: €15.
- Lunch: €25.
- Dinner: €45.
- Daily incidental allowance: €10, where permitted by local tax rules.

The allowance is not payable where a meal is provided by IronStore, a hotel, an event organiser, or a customer. Alcohol is not reimbursable as a personal travel expense. A modest amount of alcohol may be included in an

approved business meal where customary and appropriate.

Meal claims must identify all attendees when another person's meal is included. The claimant must state the business purpose and identify any customer, supplier, or public-sector attendee.

3.6 Business hospitality and team activities

Hospitality must have a clear business purpose and must not create an actual or perceived conflict of interest. It must be modest, infrequent, and appropriate to the relationship.

Claims must include:

- Date and venue.
- Business purpose.
- Names, organisations, and roles of attendees.
- Total amount and currency.
- Approval evidence where pre-approval was required.

Hospitality involving public officials, regulators, or government-owned entities requires review by Legal and Compliance before the commitment is made. Cash gifts, gift cards, personal gifts, and facilitation payments are prohibited.

Team meals and events may be reimbursed when approved by the department head and charged to the relevant team budget. The normal limit is €75 per attendee, including taxes and service charges. Events must not exclude employees on the basis of protected characteristics or religious observance.

3.7 Home-working and incidental expenses

Employees may claim approved business equipment or home-working supplies only where the item is not available through IronStore's standard equipment catalogue. Requests must be submitted through **ServiceNow** before purchase.

Examples of potentially reimbursable items include:

- Ergonomic accessories approved by Workplace Services.
- Required stationery or shipping materials.
- Business calls or connectivity costs where no company alternative exists.
- Work-related visas, vaccinations, or travel documentation.

Furniture, utilities, broadband, and personal office improvements are not reimbursable unless expressly covered by the employee's local employment terms or a country-specific agreement.

3.8 Receipts, VAT, and foreign currency

Original itemised receipts are required for expenses of €25 or more, or for any expense where local tax rules require evidence. Bank or card statements alone are not sufficient.

A compliant receipt should show:

- Supplier name and date.
- Items or services purchased.
- Amount, currency, and applicable VAT.
- VAT number where relevant.

If a receipt is unavailable, the employee must complete the **Missing Receipt Declaration** in SpendHub, explain the circumstances, and obtain manager approval. Repeated missing receipts may result in claim rejection or suspension of card privileges.

Foreign-currency expenses are converted using the card settlement rate. Personal payments are converted using the European Central Bank rate on the transaction date, as calculated by SpendHub. Employees must not claim foreign-exchange mark-ups, exchange fees, or cash withdrawal fees unless directly incurred for business purposes and documented.

3.9 Submission, review, and payment

Claims must be submitted in SpendHub within 30 calendar days of the expense date. Month-end claims should be submitted by the third working day of the following month. Claims submitted more than 90 days late require Finance Director approval.

The claimant must select the correct:

- Legal entity.
- Cost centre.
- Project or campaign code.
- Expense category.
- VAT treatment.

Line managers review business purpose, reasonableness, and budget availability. Finance Operations checks documentation, tax treatment, duplicate claims, and policy compliance. Approved claims are normally paid within the next available payroll or weekly accounts-payable run, depending on the employee's country.

Rejected claims are returned through SpendHub with a reason. The employee may correct and resubmit within 15 calendar days. Disputes should first be raised with the line manager and then with the Finance Operations Manager.

4. Roles and Responsibilities

- **Employees and cardholders:** Spend responsibly, obtain approvals, retain evidence, and submit accurate claims on time.
- **Line managers:** Confirm business need, reasonableness, budget ownership, and attendee details.
- **Budget owners:** Monitor departmental spending and approve exceptions within delegated authority.
- **Finance Operations:** Process claims, apply tax and VAT controls, monitor overdue reconciliations, and maintain guidance.

- **Finance Business Partners:** Advise on unusual spend, budgets, and policy exceptions.
- **Legal and Compliance:** Review hospitality, gifts, public-official interactions, and potential conflicts of interest.
- **Internal Audit:** Periodically test compliance, documentation, and control effectiveness.
- **People Operations:** Support payroll treatment and country-specific employee guidance.

5. Related Documents and References

- **FIN-PUR-002 — Procurement and Purchase Order Policy**
- **FIN-CARD-003 — Corporate Card Standard**
- **FIN-APP-001 — Delegation of Authority Matrix**
- **COM-TRV-001 — Business Travel and Safety Standard**
- **COM-ETH-002 — Gifts, Hospitality and Conflicts of Interest Code**
- **ServiceNow:** Equipment and home-working requests
- **SpendHub Knowledge Centre:** Expense categories, country limits, and VAT guidance
- **TravelPerk:** Approved travel booking and cancellation guidance

6. Revision History

- **August 2026 — Version 4.0:** Consolidated travel, hospitality, card, and home-working requirements; introduced TravelPerk and revised approval thresholds.
- **March 2025 — Version 3.2:** Added country-specific VAT guidance and the Missing Receipt Declaration.
- **October 2023 — Version 3.0:** Migrated expense submission and card reconciliation from email forms to SpendHub.